



SNAPS INDIA

HYDERABAD | Express Epitaph

THE EXPRESS-
WAY (ABOVE);
ROSAIAH
OPENING THE
FLYOVER



BK RAMESH

After the defeat of his government in the 1996 Lok Sabha elections and until his death eight years later, P.V. Narasimha Rao remained the one Congressman that most of his partymates loved to hate. Rao is suddenly being resurrected by the very party that banished him to the periphery when Sonia Gandhi became the Congress party president in 1998. Hyderabad's 11.66-km long elevated expressway, the longest flyover in the country, called the P.V. Narasimha Rao Elevated Expressway, was opened on October 19 by Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister K. Rosaiah. Naming the expressway after the former prime minister may have less to do with any newfound admiration for him and more with local politics in the run-up to the municipal elections. The local Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen (MIM) is demanding the flyway be named after Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy. The outfit holds Rao responsible for the demolition of the Babri Masjid. The MIM's demand that the expressway be named after Reddy is likely to strike a chord with followers of the late chief minister who have been demanding that Rosaiah be replaced by Y.S. Jaganmohan Reddy, YSR's MP-son. The CPI(M), which has emerged as the bugbear of the MIM in the old city, has joined its protest in a devious vote-seeking campaign. The Congress' troubles in Andhra Pradesh may just have begun. *by Amarnath K. Menon*

600

crore rupees
was spent on
building the
four-lane
expressway
connecting
the airport to
the city. The
initial con-
tract was for
Rs 439 crore.